

Valentin Legras

About myself

As a Senior Data Scientist and Product Owner with extensive experience in Clinical Data Science, I specialize in developing and automating reproducible workflows using R. Having successfully led the 'aNCA' open-source R package from conception to enterprise-wide adoption and mentored multiple colleagues, my goal is to secure the PKS Data Scientist & Scientific Software Engineer position. I am eager to apply my technical expertise and proven leadership skills to guide teams in building innovative, efficient, and high-impact data solutions.

My mindset

Strategy and automation entered my life long before I knew the words for them. I was around 10 years old when I started competing in basketball. To perform well against top teams across Europe, individual skill was never enough. It required strategy: analyzing opponents, optimizing plays, and finding the most efficient way to win.

Around the same time, I dived into strategic video games. I was driven to compete in environments where others could pay to get bonuses. To succeed, I had to find the most optimized path, meticulously planning and automating processes to maximize outcomes with limited resources. This wasn't just playing; it was a challenge to reverse-engineer systems, think out of the box, think about how other brains work and find the most efficient solution.

This mindset, which revolves around strategy, optimization, and automation, is a core part of my identity. I have a strong drive to find the most efficient and strategic solution to any problem. In the future, I view AI as a transformative tool that amplifies this drive, enabling me to automate complex processes and uncover optimization opportunities at a scale that wasn't possible before (via multi-agent coding). I don't only build robust and optimized systems in my professional life but also for my personal interests. As an example, I developed back-testing reproducible statistical algorithms to optimize strategies on sports betting websites and investment on S&P500 stocks (see GitHub).

Having successfully led, coached, and mentored the 'aNCA' package team of 7 developers and on-boarded new clinical and pre-clinical colleagues, I've found my greatest impact comes from combining this strategic approach with team leadership. My vision is to apply this lifelong passion for optimization at a larger scale, leading teams to build the most efficient, automated, and impactful solutions possible.

I would like to give you some rational why all my current skills makes me the ideal PKS Data Scientist & Scientific Software Engineer. This combination of deep technical expertise, product ownership, and my identity built on optimization is precisely what the position requires. A successful Lead doesn't just manage tasks, they build a strategy, an automated environment, and a technical vision.

- **Proven Team Leadership:** My work leading the 'aNCA' package proves that I can successfully mentor a team (7 developers), set a clear vision, and deliver a complex product from concept to enterprise-wide adoption.
- **Strategic Mindset:** I use my optimization skills to build efficient systems for the team. This means automating repetitive tasks and using our resources wisely to deliver the best possible results.
- **Technical & Product Ownership:** As both a senior developer and a Product Owner, I bridge the gap between technical implementation and business value. I won't just lead a team, I will also lead the development of robust, high-impact data products.
- **Artificial intelligence:** AI is the ultimate tool to scale this philosophy. My leadership approach would involve strategically "wrapping" AI around workflows in order to automate complex analysis, optimize processes, and amplify the team's capacity. My current focus is scaling multi-agent coding

workflows to automate complex development tasks, boosting team velocity while ensuring high-level engineering standards through AI-augmented issue creation, automated problem solving, and code reviews.

I am ready to lead a larger team, applying this mindset to solve complex problems through practical strategy, and automation to solve the most challenging problems.

Sincerely

Valentin Legras

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